

1 MYFITNESSPAL

MyFitnessPal is a popular mobile app that helps people track what they eat and how active they are each day. The app is designed to allow users to log their meals with detailed information on the nutrition of the meals. In addition, the app also lets the user track their workouts and exercise and give information on that as well. It's designed to help users make healthier decisions by providing detailed feedback about what they are eating and how many calories they are burning each day. The app also has specialized functionalities that help with logging meals, such as the barcode scanner and food nutrition calculator. The app is able to scan barcodes from packaged foods and calculate exactly the nutrition behind the meal for the user, and if the user is having a home made meal, the app can take the weight or number of the ingredients to give all the nutrition of the meal. While the app is great in giving the user plenty of information on meals and exercise, it still relies heavily on users remembering to log everything and staying motivated on their own. According to the Health Belief Model, simply reducing barriers isn't enough to change behavior long term [1].

2 REDESIGN

The first redesign of MyFitnessPal revolves around improving cues to action construct of HBM. Currently, the technology only has basic generic reminders to exercise and log meals. With such generalized notifications, it does not incentivize anyone to actively participate in using the app. The redesign proposes a more personalized reminder system that takes into account the user's habits and data. For example, if I end up skipping breakfast the day before then the next morning the app could then say "Good Morning Peter! You skipped breakfast yesterday, so why don't we start the day with a healthy breakfast today instead?". HBM states that cues to action help push people to actually participate in healthy behavior once they know about it. This redesign idea takes into account this aspect of HBM along with the idea from Fogg where timely cues are much more effective than generic ones at prompting healthy behaviors [2].

The second redesign of the current application focuses on improving the perceived benefits the user has from using the app. The original app lets the user set weight loss goals and track their current weight. However, besides seeing the current weight loss shown, there's no sense of benefits from this function. The new design gives the users constant feedback and progress updates that reinforce progress, such as streak badges, milestone celebrations, community engagement support and a full timeline dashboard of your personal journey. The badges and milestone celebrations will be received on completing minor goals, which can then be posted on community boards to share with others. Seeing the progress visually should make the benefits of using the app more rewarding, and making them easier to achieve will continually support more progress. The Health Belief Model suggests that individuals who are more likely to continue engaging in healthy habits stems from the belief that the benefits are more achievable and sees more results. Mayer's theory suggests that visual information helps enhance retention and focus [3]. Taking both of these ideas into account, the redesign is meant to help users more clearly see the efforts they put in pay off while improving their motivation for a healthier life.

I believe that both redesigns for myFitnessPal would be able to help people develop better lifestyles since both designs focus on improving gaps that HBM suggests the app is missing. The app should now give a more dynamic personalized encouragement system along with stronger visual progress that reinforce healthy habits. The new design offers a more long term oriented goal which celebrates smaller steps within the overarching goal to keep users more motivated. In addition by better timing personal data to trigger reminders and motivation, the app is able to keep users more emotionally invested in the goals. The personalized notification system gives the user a more specific incentive to continue with good habits since the customization of the notifications would subtly imprint a sense of responsibility and closeness to the user. Users would be more likely to be more motivated to continue with the app. The redesign of the community and milestone celebrations also gives the user a better perceived benefit that is socially reinforcement through engagement. With users being able to feel more benefitted through multiple achievements and encouragement from the community they will be more inclined to sustain the behavior to continue receiving benefits. Studies in

health communication have shown that social motivation increases adherence to healthy behaviors by making them more meaningful and supported [4]. Overall the redesign is specifically designed to better remind and incentive the user of healthy habits while reinforcing the habit with rewards and successful encouragement.

3 SOCIAL FACTOR IMPACTS

Social support is one of the key supporting factors behind the redesign's community functionality. Social support refers to the emotional and physical support that people can receive from the community, friends, and family [4]. It can be a major factor in the mental health of an individual which ultimately triggers positive or negative behaviors, which is why it is important to have strong helpful social support. With constant social support, you can help reduce stress, improve mentality, and provide encouragement in all aspects of life. On the other hand, a lack of social support, or worse, a negative community experience can drive a person's mental health down and drastically hurt a person's mindset, killing motivation and reinforcing bad habits instead. This explains why people who feel supported are more likely to stay motivated and consistent with health related goals and tasks.

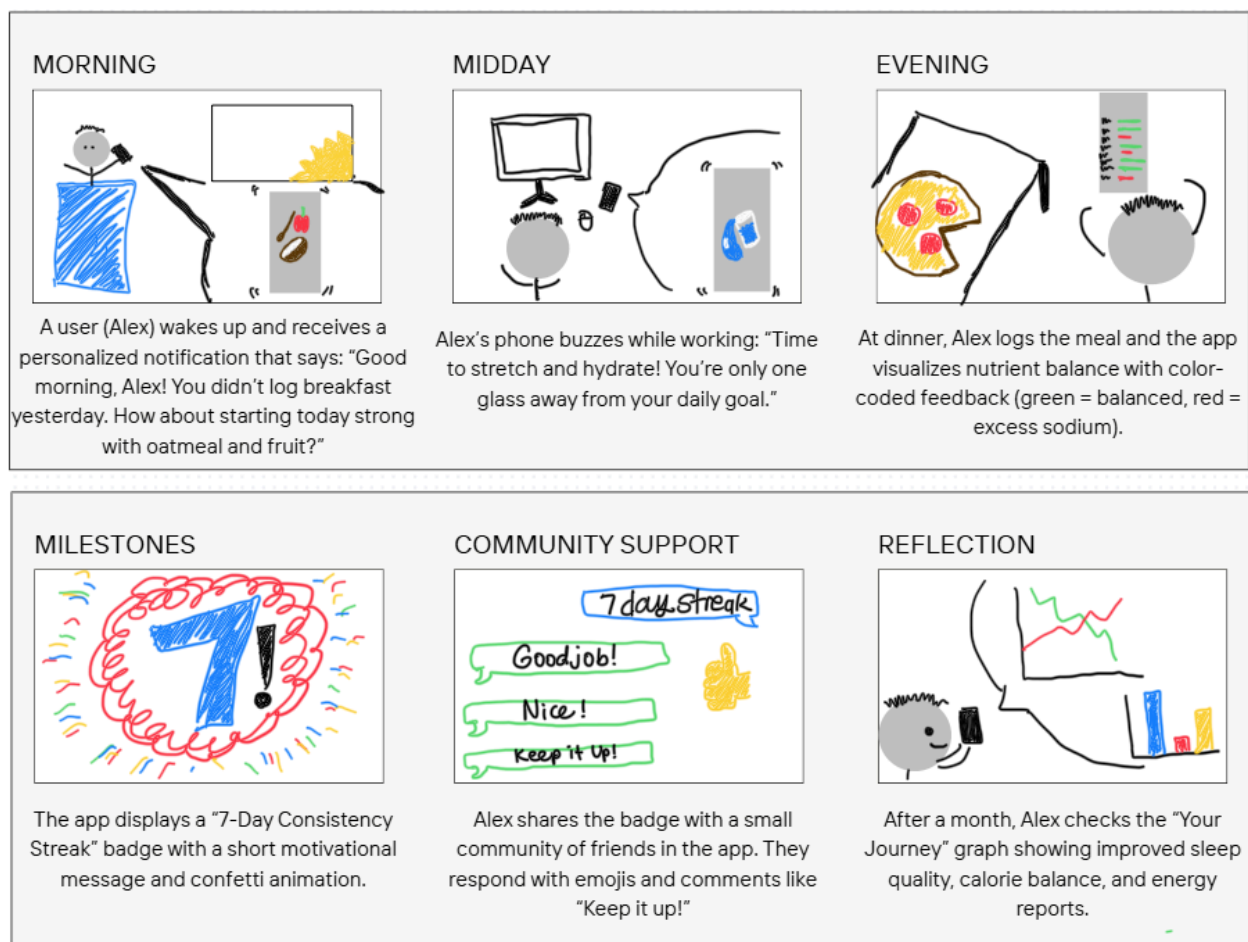
While this redesign of myFitnessPal allows for social support to be integrated straight into one of its key features, there are possible inequalities that arise from this design. The feature is meant to have a more rewarding aspect to finishing goals and receiving achievements and adorations from the community, but depending on the social environment of the community some users may not experience the support the way it is intended. The community support is dependent on others giving support and encouragement to the user; however, the online community can be in many ways critical on certain aspects. Other aspects that define a user, such as culture, race, habits, and economics can still slip into communities such as this redesign to negatively affect users. Minority and majority groups with bias and ill intentions can still affect the user through comments that are meant to be positive and affirming. This can ultimately create an opposite effect of the intended goal of the redesign and mentally damage users instead causing a greater gap in health disparities instead. Although this technology's redesign is meant to empower users and motivate them to build healthier habits, depending on the environment there could be many ways health disparities can be widened instead.

4 REFERENCES

1. I. M. Rosenstock, "The Health Belief Model and preventive health behavior," *Health Education Monographs*, vol. 2, pp. 354–386, 1974.
2. B. J. Fogg, *A Behavior Model for Persuasive Design*, Stanford Persuasive Tech Lab, 2009.
3. R. E. Mayer, *Multimedia Learning*, 2nd ed., New York, NY: Cambridge Univ. Press, 2009.
4. S. Cohen and T. A. Wills, "Stress, social support, and the buffering hypothesis," *Psychological Bulletin*, vol. 98, no. 2, pp. 310–357, 1985.

5 APPENDIX

5.A Storyboard



I have not used generative AI to prepare this assignment.